

investing is cutting down your fees, both financial advisory fees and expense ratios on mutual funds.

While these sound small at a mere 1 percent (insert sarcasm here), combined they can take away over half of your compounded potential net worth forty years down the road. That's insane!

Now I am content matching the market by buying low-cost total stock market index funds and focusing on pumping as much money into those funds as possible month after month, year after year with the full anticipation that I'll have performed better than any of those "experts" could have done when factoring in the corrosive impact of fees.

This path to FI has challenges. The first is that having a high savings rate is the only lever you can pull. For those with low incomes, student loans, or other personal challenges that prevent having a high savings rate, this path to FI is slow until you can address those issues.

Another challenge is the lack of control over investment performance. The beauty of the simple path lies in its passivity, but